introduced extreme violence in the society, which induced fear, uncertainty and enlarged risk perceptions, resulting in social upheaval, economic debility and international isolation. In fact, within less than a decade, terrorism engulfed Pakistan.

Chapter 1 makes the case for an understanding of the genesis and background of extremism and militancy in Pakistan. It begins with an in-depth insight into the history of the role of religion in struggles for autonomy and freedom from oppression and foreign rules. In this chapter, the author states that Muslims are always religion-oriented during wars, conquests and tough times. The spirit of jihad almost always figured prominently in all their struggles. Jihad literally means struggle. In the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries, the struggles in the Caucasus, Algeria and India were led by Muslim personalities who transformed them into jihad.

In India, Shah Waliullah, Syed Ismail and Syed Ahmed Barelvi waged armed jihad against Sikhs and British governments. In addition, other unarmed reformist movements were involved in such activities. After the so-called Indian War of Independence, that was, the 1857 mutiny against the British, the struggle initiated by Dadu Mian and Titumir in Bengal had tangible religious hues. The Deobandi and Barelvi schools of thought, which resulted in the two most popular Muslim sects in the Indian sub-continent, also originated in the same era of foreign rule and oppression.

The movement for the creation of a separate homeland for the Muslims of India was also mobilised on the same lines. Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the founder of Pakistan, was a moderate, modern and pragmatic person who envisaged a separate homeland for the Muslims of India because he considered them to deserve a nation different from Hindus in order for their economic and political rights to be safeguarded from the Hindu-dominated India. He conceived Pakistan as a modern democratic Muslim state but not a theocratic state. Extremist religious leaders could not play important roles and acquire recognition throughout the struggle for Pakistan. Unsurprisingly religious slogans and the strong spirit of fighting for Islam remained the hall mark of the struggle.

Muhammad Ali Jinnah died a year after the creation of Pakistan. However, his successors changed the idea of his vision of liberal Pakistan. Ruler after ruler, both civil and military, succumbed to the pressure of religious groups and made amendments to the constitution and formulated